Past simple: regular verbs

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

Qué vas a aprender

- Talk about finished actions with regular verbs (acciones terminadas)
- Write the -ed ending with the correct spelling
- Pronounce -ed in three ways: /t/, /d/ and /ɪd/
- Make negatives and questions with didn't and did

Para pensar

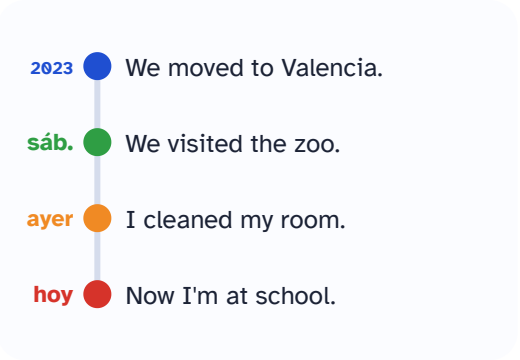
Hoy *I play* al fútbol. Ayer... ¿cómo se dice «jugué»?

Explicación

Finished actions

We use the past simple to talk about actions that **started and finished in the past**: «Yesterday I **cleaned** my room», «Last Saturday we **visited** the zoo», «In 2023 my family **moved** to Valencia».

The action is over: it is not happening now. That's why we usually say **when** it happened: *yesterday, last night, last week, three days ago, in 2022*. **En castellano:** equivale a «limpié», «visitamos», «se mudó». Y una gran ventaja: el verbo inglés **no cambia** con la persona: *I walked, you walked, he walked, we walked*.



The rule: add -ed

Most verbs are regular. To make the past, we just add **-ed**: walk → walk**ed**, play → play**ed**, watch → watch**ed**, help → help**ed**, cook → cook**ed**, start → start**ed**, open → open**ed**, jump → jump**ed**.

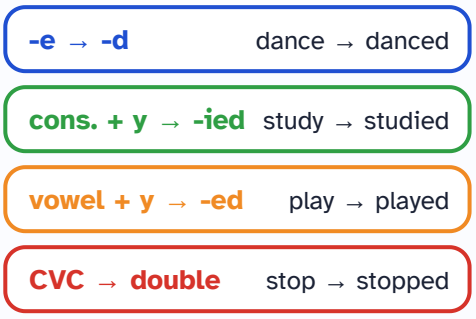
It's the same for **all persons**: «I listen**ed**», «She listen**ed**», «They listen**ed**». We don't add -s for he or she in the past. Compare: «She **plays** the piano every day» (present) and «She **played** the piano yesterday» (past).

Verb	Past	Verb	Past
walk	walked	help	helped
play	played	cook	cooked
watch	watched	open	opened
jump	jumped	start	started

Spelling: -d, -ied and double letters

Some verbs need a little change. **1.** Verbs ending in **-e** add only -d: like → like**d**, dance → dance**d**, live → live**d**, arrive → arrive**d**.

2. Consonant + **y** changes to -ied: study → stud**ied**, carry → carr**ied**, try → tr**ied**. But vowel + y just adds -ed: play → play**ed**, enjoy → enjoy**ed**. **3.** Short verbs ending in **consonant + vowel + consonant** double the last letter: stop → sto**pp**ed, plan → pla**nn**ed, hug → hu**gg**ed, drop → dro**pp**ed.



Three ways to say -ed

The ending *-ed* doesn't always sound the same. It has three sounds. **/t/** after sounds like p, k, s, sh, ch, f: walked («uokt»), jumped, washed, laughed. **/d/** after most other sounds: played («pleid»), opened, cleaned, lived.

/ɪd/ only after **t** or **d**, and then it adds a new syllable: wanted («uón-tid»), started, needed, decided. **En castellano:** el error más típico es pronunciar «-ed» entero siempre: «uók-ed». Solo se dice así cuando el verbo acaba en t o d.



Negatives with didn't

For the negative we use didn't (did not) + the verb **without -ed**. «I **didn't watch** TV.» «He **didn't play** in the match.» «We **didn't finish** the puzzle.»

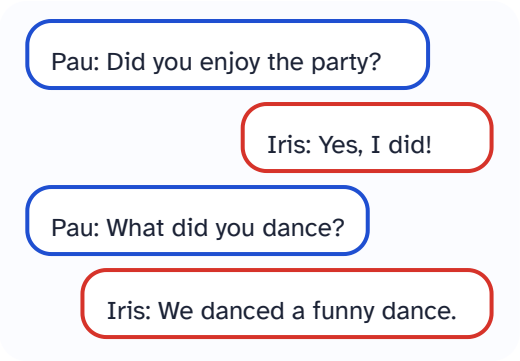
Why without -ed? Because *did* already tells us it's the past, so the verb goes back to its basic form. Never say «I didn't watched». **En castellano:** es como en el presente con *don't* y *doesn't*: el auxiliar se lleva el tiempo y el verbo queda «limpio».



Questions with did

For questions, put Did at the start + subject + verb without -ed: «**Did** you **enjoy** the party?» «**Did** she **call** you?» Short answers: «Yes, I **did**.» «No, she **didn't**.»

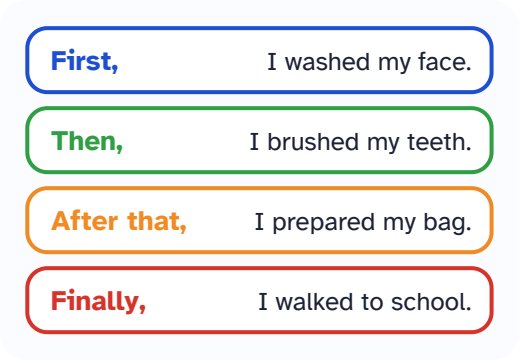
With question words: «**What did** you **cook**?» «**Where did** they **travel**?» «**When did** the film **start**?» **Ojo:** no confundas con *was/were*: para el verbo to be no usamos did («Were you tired?»), pero para el resto de verbos, sí («Did you walk?»).



Sequencing words

When we tell a story in the past, we use sequencing words to put the actions in order: **First** (primero), **Then** (luego), **Next** (después), **After that** (después de eso) and **Finally** (por último).

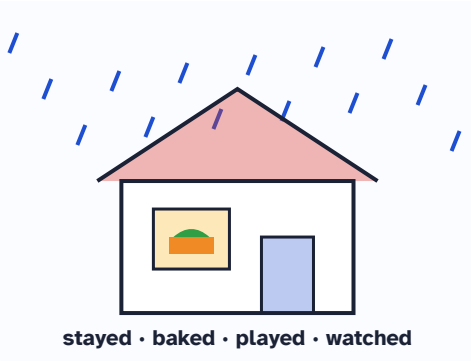
«**First**, I washed my face. **Then**, I brushed my teeth. **After that**, I prepared my bag. **Finally**, I walked to school.» These words make your text clear and easy to follow. Use a **comma** after them when they start the sentence.



Reading: a rainy Saturday

Read Nora's text: «Last Saturday it rained all day, so I stayed at home. First, I helped my dad in the kitchen. We baked a carrot cake and it smelled great! Then, I tidied my room and I discovered an old board game under the bed. After that, my brother and I played it for two hours. He laughed a lot because I lost every time. In the evening we watched a film and we chatted with my cousins on the computer. I didn't open my books, but I enjoyed the day.»

Find ten regular verbs. Which ones have /ɪd/? Which verb is in the negative?



stayed · baked · played · watched

Let's practise: what did you do?

Play «Find someone who...». Walk around the class and ask: «**Did you** watch a film last weekend?» «**Did you** visit your grandparents?» «**Did you** cook something?» When someone says «Yes, I did», write their name.

Then write a short report: «Lola **watched** a film. Max **visited** his grandparents. Nobody **cooked**.» **Repaso:** + *-ed* en afirmativa; *didn't* + verbo sin -ed en negativa; *Did...?* + verbo sin -ed en pregunta.

Did you...?	Name
watch a film?	Lola
visit your family?	Max
cook something?	—
play a sport?	Sara

Regular verbs

most verbs	spelling	negative	question
-ED	**-D / -IED**	**DIDN'T**	**DID...?**
walked played	liked, studied stopped	didn't walk no -ed!	Did you play? Yes, I did.

Ejercicios

1. **Write the past: clean, love, carry, plan.**

2. **Complete: «Yesterday we ___ (visit) the castle.»**

3. **Complete: «My cat ___ (jump) on the table.»**

4. **Make it negative: «I studied for the test.»**

5. **Make a question: «You listened to the radio.»**

6. **Answer: «Did your team play well?» (yes)**

7. **Classify by sound /t/, /d/, /ɪd/: needed, washed, opened.**

8. **Correct: «We stoped at the shop and walkt home.»**

9. **Order: «didn't / he / the / tidy / room»**

10. **Write four sentences about yesterday with First, Then, After that, Finally.**

Practica

1. **The past of «watch» is...**
   - **A)** watcht
   - **B)** watchied
   - **C)** watched
2. **The past of «like» is...**
   - **A)** liked
   - **B)** likeed
   - **C)** likied
3. **The past of «study» is...**
   - **A)** studyed
   - **B)** studied
   - **C)** studed
4. **The past of «play» is...**
   - **A)** plaied
   - **B)** played
   - **C)** playd
5. **The past of «stop» is...**
   - **A)** stoped
   - **B)** stopt
   - **C)** stopped
6. **«She didn't ___ the window.»**
   - **A)** open
   - **B)** opened
   - **C)** opens
7. **«___ you help your dad?»**
   - **A)** Do
   - **B)** Were
   - **C)** Did
8. **In «wanted», -ed sounds...**
   - **A)** /t/

B) /ɪd/

C) /d/

9. **In «jumped», -ed sounds...**

A) /t/

B) /ɪd/

C) /d/

10. **Which word puts actions in order?**

A) Then

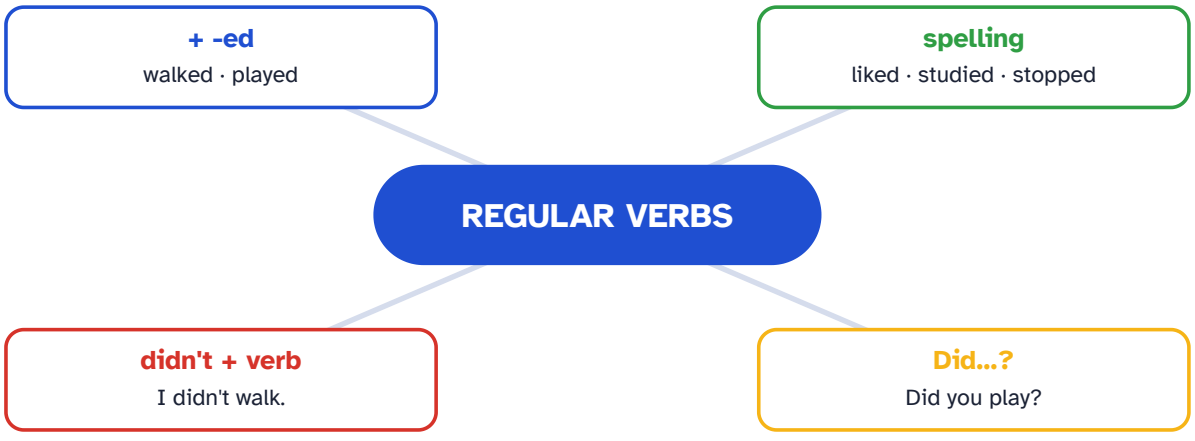
B) Yesterday

C) Because

Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Para qué sirve el pasado simple; Cómo se forma el pasado de un verbo regular y sus reglas de ortografía; Cómo se pronuncia la terminación -ed; Cómo se hacen negativas y preguntas con did.

Resumen



Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

Regular verb

Hace el pasado con -ed.

-e → -d

like → liked.

consonante + y → -ied

study → studied.

doble consonante

stop → stopped.

/t/ /d/ /ɪd/

walked · played · wanted.

didn't + verbo

I didn't play.

Did...?

Did you play? Yes, I did.

First, then, finally

Ordenan lo que pasó.

Soluciones

1. **C)** Regla general: + -ed.
2. **A)** Acaba en -e: + d.
3. **B)** Consonante + y → -ied.
4. **B)** Vocal + y: + ed.
5. **C)** Se dobla la consonante.
6. **A)** Tras didn't, sin -ed.
7. **C)** Pregunta en pasado: Did.
8. **B)** Tras t: sílaba nueva.
9. **A)** Tras p: /t/.
10. **A)** Then = luego.

Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. cleaned, loved, carried, planned.
2. visited.
3. jumped.
4. I didn't study for the test.
5. Did you listen to the radio?
6. Yes, it did. / Yes, they did.
7. needed /ɪd/, washed /t/, opened /d/.
8. We stopped at the shop and walked home.
9. He didn't tidy the room.
10. Model answer: First, I walked to school. Then, I played with my friends. After that, I helped my mum. Finally, I watched TV.